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M.Tech is suitable for a product-based industry where technical skills are required. MBA is more suitable for a service- and customer-oriented industry

fresher who has an additional degree of MBA or M.Tech. But this completely depends on his capabilities and the management's views.

However, a more qualified candidate usually enjoys a better compensation in the long run. This is more so if the master's degree is completed from a reputed institute.

Some really good institutes for studying M.Tech are all the IITs, Delhi Technological University (formerly Delhi College of Engineering), Netaji Subhas Institute of Technology (NSIT), NITs and Birla Institute of Technology & Science (BITS). Some MBA colleges of repute are all the IIMs, FMS, XLRI and IIFT. IIMs top the list in MBA training.

Starting off

To enrol for M.Tech in a reputed institute like IITs, you need to crack GATE. In case you plan to pursue MBA, there are entrance exams like CAT and MAT which you need to clear.

Though it is easier to continue M.Tech in the stream as you did your BE or B.Tech, you have many options for doing M.Tech—electronics and controls engineering, VLSI design communication systems, embedded systems technology, power electronics and drives, digital communication and networking, remote sensing and GIS, information technology, computer science and engineering, and biomedical and instrumentation engineering to name a few.

When on the job, you learn to put your theoretical knowledge into use, but to improve upon your knowledge of design or research aspect,

you need to go for the masters. It, however, will be difficult to crack the entrance exam (GATE) while you are on job. So it is recommended to qualify the GATE exam in the final year of study and get a job thereafter, as GATE score is valid for two years.

MBA, on the other hand, is preferable after you have gained some work experience.

Part-time: Good choice for working professionals

If you are a working professional who cannot take time off work to attend full-time, a part-time programme will give you the opportunity to pursue an advanced degree. Academically, part-time programmes are identical to full-time programmes. With the part-time programme, you can work full-time while attending classes on days off or in the evenings. So you can improve existing skills or develop new ones without affecting your current job.

To pursue a part-time/evening programme in M.Tech, the minimum eligibility is B.Tech/M.Sc or equivalent in relevant field with CGPA of 6.75 on a 10-point scale or 60 per cent marks in aggregate for general category, and some work experience. You must submit no objection certificate from your employer at the time of interview. Selection is generally made on the basis of a written test and/or interview.

Similarly, many colleges and universities offer part-time MBA programmes. The advantage of a part-time MBA programme is that you can bring and discuss real-world situations and problems into the classroom, where solutions can be explored that could be implemented in real life. In fact, such presentations and discussions make the classes more interesting.

Tuition assistance and student loans may be available. Also, there are many employers who sponsor their candidates for higher education.

A part-time programme will also